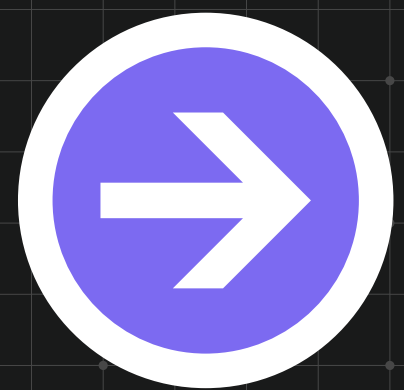


SHREYA PANDEY

State Management in ASP.NET Core



 Session, Cookies, Cache, TempData & More

SWIPE

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? HTTP is Stateless...

So how does ASP.NET Core remember:

- ✓ Logged-in user
- ✓ Cart items
- ✓ Form data
- ✓ User preferences
- ✓ Temp messages (Success/Error)

➔ That's where State Management comes in.

Types of State

- **Client-Side State**

Stored in browser/device

Examples: Cookies, LocalStorage

- **Server-Side State**

Stored on server

Examples: Session, Cache, DB

Cookies (Client-Side)

✓ **Best for: small user preferences**

⚡ **Fast & simple**

⚠ **Size limit: ~4KB**

⚠ **Can be modified by the user**

📌 **Use for:**

- Theme (Dark/Light)
- Language selection
- Remember me

Client-Side State: TempData

● TempData (Short-Lived)

✓ Used between 2 requests
(Redirect scenario)

📌 Common in MVC apps

Example:

✓ "Profile updated successfully!"

⚠ Automatically removed after
reading.

Server-Side State: Session

🧠 **Session (Server-Side)**
Stores data per user session.

✓ **Best for:**

- Shopping cart
- Multi-step forms
- OTP verification flow

⚠ **Needs configuration + storage provider**

⚠ **Don't store large objects**

Caching for State

⚡ Caching (Fastest State)

Used to store frequently accessed data.

✓ Types in ASP.NET Core:

- IMemoryCache (in-memory)
- Distributed Cache (Redis / SQL)

📌 Use for:

- Product list
- Settings
- Dashboard data

Database State (Permanent)

When state must survive:

- ✓ Server restart
- ✓ Session expiry
- ✓ App scaling



Best for:

- User profile data
- Orders
- Saved drafts
- Audit logs

Which One Should You Use?

Quick Decision Guide

- ✓ Cookies → small preferences
- ✓ TempData → one-time message after redirect
- ✓ Session → user-specific short data
- ✓ Cache → fast reusable data
- ✓ Database → permanent + reliable data

Final Tip

If your app is scaled (multiple servers):

- ➔ Prefer Distributed Cache / DB
- ✗ Avoid heavy Session dependency

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